Making my emotion piece teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Create art linked to an emotion (links PSHE).

Today: I can make a small piece linked to a feeling.

Success criteria

I can use my plan to make a piece.

I can show a start and an end.

I can say how one choice fits my feeling.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four real trials and plans, four books or arts logs and four pencils. Have eight scrap pieces for honest catch-up trials or one changed ending.

Paint route: four small sheets, five brushes including the adult model, four mats, two stable water pots, familiar washable paint and cloths. Keep wet materials away from electrical items.

Sound route: quiet fingertips or comfortable soft knee taps, no instrument or recording device required. Offer a quiet practice space and a silent route.

Adult model: the actual short plan and a small piece made from it. Keep four individual storage places and a flat drying space.

Materials-free route: silent hand sequence, air drawing or pupil-directed adult performance. Keep a dated observed sequence and the pupil's confirmed words when recording is available.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Show the actual model plan. Say: My piece is about hope. My plan starts with one curve and ends with three.

15 to 30 seconds: Make the first curve with a light brush touch or in the air. Leave a gap. Say: I follow my chosen order.

30 to 45 seconds: Add the three ending curves. Or perform four soft slow taps, pause, then repeat and stop. Say: My piece has a start and an end.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to one chosen feature. Say: I keep the space because it fits my idea. I keep my real work and review together.

Arrival and starter

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Find your real trial and plan. Point to the feeling, start and end. If you were away, make a small plan today.

What to say: Find your own trial and plan from yesterday. Tell or show me the emotion, first part and last part. If a plan is missing or you were away, choose a feeling and make a short trial now. We record today's date and do not invent an earlier test.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies their actual plan or makes an honest short restart. The intended emotion and order are clear enough for a manageable piece.

Materials free fallback: The adult reads back only a witnessed prior sequence. If no record exists, offer two silent patterns and let the pupil choose and plan one now.

Check and response: A fresh plan is valid. Keep the date and reason for the restart honest. A pupil may change the plan if they can show the new choice.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Watch a start, a pause and an end. Watch the end first, then the start. What changed? Which order fits your idea?

What to say: I show one small air curve, pause, then three open curves. Now I reverse the order. The same parts can feel different in a new order. Which order might fit hope, calm or another feeling? Explain your own reading.

What good looks like: The pupil notices that the order changed and links a chosen order to an intention. No feeling is treated as a fixed answer.

Materials free fallback: Use seated finger movements or describe 'one curve, then three curves'. A pupil can direct the order without moving.

Check and response: The parts are the same but their order changed. Growing from one mark to three might suggest hope to one maker; another reading is valid with a reason.

Modelling and cover guidance

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch a plan become a small piece. Make the start. Leave a space or pause. Make the end. Check the chosen feeling. Keep or change one part for a reason.

What to say: My plan says hope: one small curve, then three open curves. On the left I make the first curve. I leave space, then make the ending on the right. I look back at the plan. I can keep this ending or change the space if that helps my idea. In sound, I perform four soft slow taps, pause, then repeat, and stop. I keep a simple action plan so the work can be described. This is an adult model.

What good looks like: The adult uses the real model plan to make a coherent small piece with an identifiable beginning and ending. A keep or change decision links to the intended emotion, not only to neatness.

Materials free fallback: Perform or direct a silent hand sequence with a clear beginning and ending. The adult can describe the ordered actions without needing a recording device.

Check and response: Ask: 'Did my piece use my chosen order?' If unclear, point to the two planned parts and match them to the actual piece before moving on.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the task and make two tiny tests in paint, sound or silent hand movement. Let pupils choose a feature and make a short response. Use the same timings and log prompts. No specialist demonstration is needed. If prior work is missing, use a fresh trial with today's date.

Guided practice and making

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Help make one small class piece. Check its start and end against the plan. Say one part to keep or change. The maker makes the final choice.

What to say: You direct our class piece for a made-up person. I will follow the chosen order. Tell me what you notice before offering a change. Hinge: A listener reads the piece differently. Must the maker A change it at once, or B hear the idea and then choose for their own purpose?

What good looks like: The pupil checks the work against the plan and makes a reasoned keep or change decision. The pupil understands that feedback can inform a choice while the maker keeps control.

Materials free fallback: Direct the adult through a silent sequence. Use an agreed gesture to choose keep or change. The adult confirms the pupil's reason in their own words.

Check and response: B. The maker can listen, then keep or change a feature for a reason. If unclear, model two different readings of the same curve. Parallel check: 'Can the maker keep the curve and explain why?' Expected: yes. Return to individual making when the pupil can choose a feature and a reason.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, find your plan. Make your small painting, sound or silent piece. Give it a clear start and end. Check one part. Keep or change it and say why. Keep your work and your own words.

What to say: Make a piece small enough for this lesson. Use your planned order or record a new choice. With paint, use a small amount, keep water on the mat, and rinse and wipe the brush before a new colour. Let wet marks dry before painting over them. With sound, use gentle taps below talking volume and stop on my raised hand. You may practise quietly before showing me. Check one feature, such as space, mark shape, pace or pause. Keep it or change it for a reason linked to the emotion. An adult may handle materials under your direction.

What good looks like: An original emotion-linked piece with a deliberate beginning and ending, a pupil-owned choice and a brief review. If unfinished, retain the real stage and next step rather than naming it finished. A sound or movement piece may be brief and still complete for the lesson.

Materials free fallback: Make or direct a silent hand piece or air drawing with a beginning and ending. The adult records the observed order and the pupil's confirmed emotion, choice and review when a recording method is available. No art materials, instrument or device is required for participation.

Check and response: Example only: the pupil keeps a gap between two parts because it suggests waiting to them. Another pupil may remove a gap to show joy. Both are valid purposeful choices.

Review and evidence

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Share with an adult or a partner. Say: My piece is about ___. Show how one part fits your feeling. Tidy and keep your piece with your log.

What to say: The listener describes one feature before asking the maker about the intention. The maker says what they chose and why. You may share privately or pass on a public performance. Use the final two minutes to cap paint, wipe mats and store work flat. Sound and movement pupils keep their sequence plan or dated witness note beside their log.

What good looks like: The pupil links a real feature to the intended emotion and hears a respectful observation. Actual work, plan and review remain together. Interpretation belongs to the maker.

Materials free fallback: The adult witnesses a silent sequence privately and reads a short description back for the pupil to confirm or correct.

Check and response: Useful review: 'My piece is about calm. I kept the slow pace because it feels still to me.' Avoid judging a pupil's private emotional state from the work.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: I made ___. My piece is about ___. I kept or changed ___ because ___. Next I would like to ___.

What to say: Show the actual piece, plan or witnessed sequence that your words refer to. Say what you kept or changed and why. I can scribe your words, read them back and let you correct them. Record the real date, whether the piece is finished or a first version, and the help used. This entry contributes to the ongoing Explore log.

What good looks like: A dated entry identifies the emotion-linked piece and a specific artistic decision. It distinguishes pupil explanation from adult observation and records the true state of the work.

Materials free fallback: The pupil confirms the feeling, sequence and decision by gesture or speech. The adult makes an accurate dated observation note at the next recording opportunity.

Check and response: Example only: I made a small painting about hope. I kept the open curves because they seem to grow. Next I would like to try longer marks.

Access and teaching decisions

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Tuesday 12 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

A listener's different reading makes the piece wrong - The listener describes a feature. The maker explains the intention and decides whether to change anything.

More paint or louder sound makes a stronger piece - A small clear choice can work. Keep sound gentle and use a little paint; change pace, space or order instead.

A piece must be finished to keep a log entry - Record the actual stage honestly, with a next step. A first version or witnessed silent sequence can show genuine learning.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.